significant proportion of states, are willing to see as a desirable end and are committed to the idea and must 'want' it to work.

Despite several meanings and implications, balance of power remains, as Morgenthau pointed out, "a manifestation of a general social principle" in international relations.

The Prerequisites for Balance of Power

1. A multiplicity of states.
2. Absence of a centralized legitimate and strong authority over these sovereign actors.
3. Relatively unequal distribution of national power.
4. Requirement of a balancing power.
5. Perpetuation of existing power distribution which benefits the balancer nations mutually, i.e., status quo.[9]

From these assumptions arise a set of informal widely understood principles or rules:

1. Be suspicious of an increase in power by another country—any country. Be concerned with the capabilities, not intentions.
2. Always ally with the weaker side. Ignore considerations such as friendship or morality.
3. Support a state or group of states only until, it is out of danger. Remember that no alliance is permanent.
4. Show moderation towards the aggressor after it is defeated because no alliance is permanent; today's enemy may be tomorrow's ally.
5. Settle non-essential quarrels in peripheral areas in a way that does not disturb the central balance.[10]

Kaplan[11] also suggests certain basic rules for the functioning of the balance of power system:

1. Act to increase capabilities but negotiate rather than fight.
2. Fight rather than give up an opportunity to increase capabilities.
3. Stop fighting rather than eliminate an essential national actor.
4. Act to oppose any coalition or single actor which assumes a predominant position with respect to the rest of the system.